

No Gold, No Trips: Why India's PM Wants You to Stay Home

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Have you ever been told you can't have something because it costs too much? Now imagine a whole country being asked to skip vacations and not buy shiny gold. That's exactly what's happening in India.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi is asking all Indians to work from home, avoid trips to other countries, and not buy gold for at least a year. Why? A war between the US, Israel, and Iran has made oil prices shoot up. Oil is used to make fuel for cars and planes, so everything gets more expensive.

Modi spoke at an event in Hyderabad on Sunday. He said people should have online meetings instead of in-person ones, just like during the COVID-19 **pandemic**. He also asked farmers to use half the normal amount of **fertilizer**, which helps plants grow but is also made from things that come from the war zone.

The price of oil has jumped almost 50% since the war started on February 28. A barrel of **Brent crude** oil now costs \$105.45. That's a big deal because India buys a lot of oil from other countries. Modi says the country needs to save its **foreign exchange**, which is like a savings account of money from other countries. India's savings have dropped from \$728.5 billion to \$690.69 billion since the war began.

Modi said, "**Patriotism** is not only about the willingness to **sacrifice** one's life on the border. In these times, it is about living responsibly." So, for now, kids in India might see fewer new gold bangles and more parents working from the living room.

Word Treasure

fertilizer -- A substance added to soil to help plants grow, often made from chemicals or natural materials.

foreign exchange -- Money from other countries that a country saves to buy things it needs from abroad.

patriotism -- Love and loyalty to your country, shown by doing things that help it.

sacrifice -- Giving up something important or valuable for a bigger reason.

Brent crude -- A type of oil from the North Sea that is used as a standard to set prices for oil around the world.

pandemic -- A disease that spreads over a very large area, like a whole continent or the whole world.

Background you need

India is one of the world's biggest buyers of oil, so when fighting happens in oil-producing parts of the world, it can make fuel and other things much more expensive there.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi (the leader of India) is asking people to cut back on things that use a lot of foreign money so the country can keep its savings strong.

A country's foreign exchange reserves work like a family's emergency piggy bank--without enough saved, the country might struggle to pay for things it needs from other nations.

Break it down

WHO: Prime Minister Narendra Modi of India

WHAT: Called on Indians to work from home, avoid foreign travel, and not buy gold for a year to save money

WHERE: At an event in Hyderabad, India

WHY: Because a war pushed oil prices up sharply, and India needed to protect its foreign exchange savings

Why it matters

If your country asks families to skip things like gold and holidays to save national money, it can mean your parents have to change plans or work from home, and it might affect what you can afford too.

Test what you remember

1. What did Prime Minister Modi ask Indians to stop buying for at least a year?

- ☐ (A) New cars
- ☐ (B) Gold
- ☐ (C) Smartphones
- ☐ (D) Clothes

2. Why did oil prices shoot up, according to the article?

- ☐ (A) A war between the US, Israel, and Iran
- ☐ (B) A big storm in the ocean
- ☐ (C) Farmers using too much fertilizer
- ☐ (D) Too many people traveling

3. Where did Modi speak about working from home and saving money?

- ☐ (A) New Delhi
- ☐ (B) Mumbai
- ☐ (C) Hyderabad
- ☐ (D) Chennai

4. What does India need to save, according to Modi?

- ☐ (A) Gold bars
- ☐ (B) Foreign exchange
- ☐ (C) Water
- ☐ (D) Electricity

5. How much did India's savings drop since the war began?

- ☐ (A) From \$728.5 billion to \$690.69 billion
- ☐ (B) From \$800 billion to \$750 billion
- ☐ (C) From \$500 billion to \$450 billion
- ☐ (D) From \$100 billion to \$90 billion

6. What did Modi say patriotism is about in these times?

- ☐ (A) Fighting on the border
- ☐ (B) Buying gold
- ☐ (C) Living responsibly
- ☐ (D) Traveling abroad

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: C 4: B 5: A 6: C

Questions to think about

1. **Supportive:** Some people agree with Modi, saying that everyone should make small sacrifices now to help the whole country stay financially safe.
2. **Critical:** Others feel it is too much to ask families to give up celebrations, vacations, and traditional gifts like gold, especially when times are already tough.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):